

ROLEXVSGRANDSEIKO

ANALYSIS

CRITICISM

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WITHIN THE CONTEXT OF ADVERTISING DISCIPLINE

ONLINE

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01 INTRODUCTION

This work aims to carry out an analysis that seeks to compare the online presence (in the field of online advertising with an exclusive focus on Google Search Ads) from two direct competitors of the chosen brand (OMEGA) for the project final, which in this case are: Rolex and Grand Seiko.

These brands have markedly different positions with regards to the Ethos of watchmaking that they design, produce and sell, Ethos esse, which is also manifests itself in the way they build their Ads, from Headlines to Descriptions. For analysis purposes, a Paid Search Ad was chosen from each of these companies that were online on 3/11/2025.

02 CONTEXTUALIZATION

OF THE SECTOR

The luxury watchmaking sector operates at a unique intersection of engineering, art and psychology. Essentially, these brands do not sell the function of measuring time, but rather aspiration, a tangible symbol of success, heritage and status. This reality dictates that marketing is mainly based on building desire and trust, which explains the inversion of the traditional funnel: TOFU (Awareness) is typically built through expensive and emotional offline channels (sponsorships, elite events), while MOFU and BOFU (Consideration and Action) are managed with surgical precision in digital. The accelerated transition to e-commerce, amplified due to recent events, has forced brands like Rolex to defend their image with even more rigor, and growing brands like Grand Seiko using digital scientific and aggressive way to convert high purchase intention into sales immediate.

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03 DESCRIPTION OF BRANDS (ROLEX AND GRAND SEIKO)

The Rolex brand positions itself as the global icon of luxury watchmaking, with a strong emphasis on robustness, accuracy and universal recognition. Founded in 1905 in London by Hans Wilsdorf, a German, and later transferred to Geneva, the Rolex pioneered numerous technical innovations, including creating the first water-resistant case (Oyster) and automatic movement with Perpetual rotor. This history of innovation and reliability has consolidated its prestigious reputation and durability. The brand's Ethos is based on this tradition, characteristics that are clearly reflect in the way you communicate through your Marketing.

Figure 1-Print Ad Rolex

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In turn, Grand Seiko presents a more discreet and contemplative, focused on artisanal perfection and subtle technical innovation. Founded in 1960 by Seiko, Grand Seiko emerged with the aim of penetrating the luxury by creating watches that rival the best in Switzerland (still thus its first presence outside Asia was in 2017), combining engineering precision with minimalist aesthetics and artisanal finishing, characteristics that are associated with this culture. The brand's Ethos emphasizes meticulous care for each detail, high precision and natural beauty of the design, which translates into Marketing that favors more poetic and technical messages.

Figure 2-Print Ad Grand Seiko

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04 ADS CHOSEN

GRAND SEIKO:

Figure 3-Search term used in this situation was: Grand Seiko.

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ROLEX:

Figure 4- Search Term used in this situation was: Rolex

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05 FUNNEL PHASE

In the world of luxury watchmaking (or any good of this kind) people who do not know or buy our product are as important as those that do, it is this reality that makes the appeal to aspirations so strong and effective, for this reason reason, most of the budget of these brands is spent creating this aspiration (Phase of Awareness) and outside the “GSA”, leaving Google Search for the Consideration and Action.

While in the intricacies of traditional marketing a wider “net” is cast due to the fact that these means deal with the inherent difficulties of segmentation, in digital, this filtering can be performed without major difficulties. In the case of these two brands and, by extension, their competitors, the change of paradigm brought by COVID, dictated that the transition to a more dependent on digital happened sooner than perhaps they would have wanted.

This funnel distinction is crucial: the content of Print Ads (TOFU), which builds the aura of exclusivity, is the aspirational promise that the GSA has to fulfill. Analyzing the press campaigns, it is clear that Rolex (through its explorer/conquest) carries its promise of timeless authority directly to digital, refusing the explicit transaction as in its press campaigns. Grand Seiko (with its focus on subtle art and nature) uses its artisanal reputation (the Ethos built offline) as the final argument of sale in GSA.

What the customer sees in the magazine (the Aspiration) has to be validated by what the customer sees on Google (Execution). Online advertising thus becomes the functional extension of narrative established in traditional channels.

The addition of the digital aspect to operations required brands to make the decision where this medium fit in, whether in a phase of awareness, consideration or action and This analysis will demonstrate that Rolex chose to use the “GSA” as a point of primary contact in the Consideration phase, MOFU, focusing on the Image Corporate.

While Grand Seiko, focusing on market growth, integrated the GSA as a crucial channel of Action, BOFU, albeit with a secondary objective of bring some notoriety to the brand outside of Asia.

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06 KEYWORDS

Initially, keyword analysis is carried out using a strategy called “Trial and Error”, where several search terms were used that would sense to trigger the chosen ad.

Next, Google Keyword Planner is used to try to understand that other search terms could trigger the ad.

This point will be separated by brand.

GRAND SEIKO:

Keyword analysis shows that Grand Seiko prioritizes Conversion and Efficiency (BOFU) rather than broad visibility. Taking into account the objective of direct sales and the creating notoriety in the West, Grand Seiko uses a strategic mix of keywords MOFU and BOFU (the BOFU intention being preponderant). This approach aims to convert users who are in the decision phase, using information “MOFU” only when necessary to support the conversion perspective.

Grand Seiko's absolute focus on Conversion (BOFU) implies a strong dependence of high-precision match types, such as [Exact Match] and “Phrase Match”. This choice minimizes spend on more diffuse intent (MOFU) search terms, ensuring that each click has the highest potential Return on Investment (ROI).

Using “Trial and Error” it was possible to draw a good image of the Grand Seiko's strategy, the first search term that originally showed the ad was Grand Seiko which, given that it is the name of the brand, makes sense.

Afterwards, with the notion that BOFU is a target, we move on to Search Terms with intentions more specific, but still in the “MOFU” domain and here we find Search Terms like:

“grand seiko price” (shows the ad and although it may appear to belong to BOFU, it does not o é), “grand seiko model” (shows the ad), “grand seiko models” (the plural also activates the ad), “grand seiko collection” (shows the ad), “grand seiko collections” (the plural comes back on)

In search of more specific search terms (in terms of intent) we then trying to understand if “hotter” traffic is also exposed to this ad.

Search terms such as “grand seiko where to buy” show the ad, as well as “grand

seiko watch", "grand seiko price (here the singular of price also activates the ad despite

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to be a more transactional term than its predecessor, which indicates the company's desire brand of capturing the crowd of “ultimate MOFU” and BOFU) and “grand seiko acquire”.

Finally we come to the Search Terms that did not activate the ad or that activated ads alternatives, which indicates that there is more than one group of ads running in this campaign.

All the search term suggestions coming from the keyword planner did not reach activate the ad because they were, in the overwhelming majority, too vague and broad, which conflicts with the brand's objective of converting and increasing its ROI/ROAS.

Figure 5-None of these keywords managed to trigger the ad

Search terms that failed were “grand seiko watches” for being too vague and by extension too expensive and “grand seiko spring drive movement” by being too technical which suggests someone researching to find out more about the movement and not about the watches themselves.

“grand seiko boutique lisbon”, “grand seiko spring drive” and “grand seiko prices” They returned a different ad that links directly to the boutique's page.

The conclusion that can be drawn from here is that Grand Seiko uses several ad groups divided between: Main website, collections, specific models, but curiously, unlike Rolex, it does not advertise its history, which supports the thesis that despite using keywords that some fit into the MOFU phase and others BOFU, if there's one thing you're not looking for, it's TOFU traffic.

We can also theorize that due to the impossibility of activating the ad with terms related or too technical like “grand seiko spring drive movement” that the

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brand chooses to use expression matching or exact keywords and with some negative keywords (movement seems to be one of them), which aligns with the idea that you are looking for a visiting guy who has already decided or is very close to do.

Cluster 1: BOFU (Clear Purchase Intent, high ROI)

"grand seiko price" Maximum precision for clearer transactional action.

"grand seiko acquire" Greater coverage for purchase synonyms, but still focused in intention.

"grand seiko prices" Captures price search variations for Ad targeting Group.

[grand seiko boutique lisbon] Highly qualified local traffic for Ad da Boutique.

Cluster 2: Branding and High Intent MOFU (Decision Support)

[grand seiko] Core brand defense, essential to controlling the initial narrative.

"grand seiko model" / "grand seiko models" Captures users in the consideration of specific products/models.

"grand seiko collection" / "grand seiko collections" Captures traffic that is exploring the brand product lines.

"grand seiko price" MOFU/BOFU transition term that indicates a strong cost consideration.

Cluster 3: Exclusion (Inferred Negative Keywords)

- grand seiko spring drive movement - Avoids technical search traffic (TOFU) that have no intention of purchasing immediately.
- grand seiko watches - Avoid very broad and expensive consultations that reduce ROI.
- "port" - Being a place where there is no authorized seller, the brand does not want to promote yourself to this traffic. (If the search is "grand seiko lisboa" or "grand seiko portugal" the ad is shown)

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ROLEX:

If on the one hand Grand Seiko uses an approach with hybrid characteristics, the Rolex unequivocally intends to nurture and maintain its authority and status in the segment using keywords that seek to capture those who are in the consideration phase, leaving the conversion to “others” (more on this later front).

With regard to the keyword funnel phase, it is not necessary to make a distinction as both in the ad and on the website the content is strictly MOFU, which is necessary, for on the other hand, is to recognize the mastery with which Rolex maneuvers digital and specifically the Google Search Ads Universe, which is in my opinion so perfect that makes Grand Seiko's execution, despite being quite competent, look amateurish.

This analysis reveals that, in addition to the strict exclusion of BOFU terms, Rolex uses a highly segmented “GSA” structure, where the activation of different Ads for specific Search Terms proves your investment in the obsessive need for control of the narrative.

The first step was to speculate and introduce search terms with the aim of triggering the ad and in this situation it was possible to find three different outcomes, some Search Terms delivered the ad, others delivered different ads (of the same brand) and others delivered nothing.

The strategic distinction between brands is also manifested in the inferred choice of match types. Grand Seiko, with its focus on Action (BOFU) and immediate ROI, will tend predominantly using [Exact Match] ([grand seiko price]) and “Phrase Match” (“grand seiko buy”) to ensure that your ads are activated only by users with high purchase intention. On the other hand, Rolex, which operates in Consideration phase (MOFU) and aims to consolidate the image, bases its brand defense strategy. The brand bids on its terms (name and models) using almost exclusively [Exact Match] and “Phrase Match”, avoiding the risk of broader match types. However, your real control lies in the application rigorous use of negative keywords of [Exact Match] and “Phrase Match” to ensure that the Your ad is not activated by transactional or BOFU intent terms.

Terms such as: "Rolex"; "Rolex watch"; "Rolex watches"; "Rolex models"; "Rolex model";
"rolex collection"; "rolex collections"; "luxury rolex"; "used rolex" delivered our ad

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chosen, all these MOFU (and consideration) terms have a volume of high research and competition.

Rolex intends to maintain a firm grip on these terms to ensure its top position and absolute control of the narrative.

Next, we check those terms that, despite returning ads, are different

In terms of descriptions, headlines and landing pages, these are ads that target traffic, but always in the MOFU domain.

Figure 6- Example of a more specific and segmented Ad

These terms are more specific, continuing with the analogy that defines the website of Rolex as a digital catalogue, these keywords are used to open this catalog in desired page instead of “asking” the visitor to complete the act of browsing.

You will then find Search Terms such as: “rolex daytona”; “rolex submariner”; “rolex hulk submariner”; “rolex pepsi gmt”; “rolex rootbeer gmt”; “rolex gold”; “rolex steel and gold”; “Rolex Steel”; “Rolex Loja”; “Rolex Lojas”; “Rolex Boutique Lisbon”, here we see that There is already an effort to direct users to more specific pages.

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If someone has already decided that they want a Rolex, but doesn't know exactly which model they want, whether it is then “confronted” with collection pages and general models, as it was demonstrated previously, but if there is already some type of decision, be it the model specific or desired material these keywords will satisfy the search intent.

Lastly, we analyze the Search Terms that do not return ads (at least from the Rolex...) and here the words that don't give away are as important as the ones that they do.

Any Search Term that was searched for did not activate ads because what people were looking for was not something the brand wanted to associate itself with (at least less directly...).

They are: “Rolex price”; “Rolex buy”; “Rolex delivery”; “Rolex where to buy”; “Rolex investment”; “Rolex Swiss”; “Rolex Pepsi”; “Rolex Hulk”; “Rolex Rootbeer”, and by analyzing this group there are 3 characteristics that stand out within it.

Figure 7-Some of the Keyword Planner suggestions and their results

Rolex aims to avoid unqualified traffic and here you can see how the does, Search Terms like “rolex hulk” which although it may seem similar to previously mentioned “rolex hulk submariner” and who activated an ad, are ignored because this is a nickname that alone demonstrates knowledge surface of the brand, on the other hand, anyone searching for the same watch and having the knowledge about which model automatically becomes a more desirable target for Rolex.

At the same time, you wish to disassociate your name from the purchasing process and here We possibly found some negative keywords that support this objective, the fact that Search Terms that contain “price”, “buy” and “delivery” do not delivering “ad” leads us to believe that Rolex placed these terms as keywords negative to avoid “tying” your name to the transactional phase of luxury.

Finally, remove yourself from associations with other Swiss watch producers (perhaps because they consider that it transcends origin) and the public that considers watches as an investment and thus transactional goods (when the brand intends to show the

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its reliability and timeless qualities) by removing the term pool such as "Swiss Rolex" and "Investment Rolex".

Cluster 4: MOFU (Brand Defense and General Domain

[rolex] Absolute control of the main term to dominate the search result page.

"rolex watches" / "rolex watch" Captures all traffic looking for watches from brand.

"Rolex models" / "Rolex model" Captures users exploring the catalog in general.

"luxury rolex" / "pre-owned rolex" Controls the narrative around terms of value and secondary and used market.

Cluster 5: MOFU (Catalog Targeting and Specific Ads)

[rolex daytona] / [rolex submariner] Directs the user to the exact page of the model.

"rolex hulk submariner" / "rolex pepsi gmt" Captures specific nickname intent which includes the model name (qualified traffic).

"gold rolex" / "steel and gold rolex" Captures intent based on material, segmenting a Ad for relevant collections.

[rolex boutique lisboa] Captures the intention of visiting, directing to the store page (MOFU, not transactional BOFU).

Cluster 6: Inferred Negative Keywords (BOFU and TOFU Exclusion)

- rolex price / -rolex prices / -rolex buy Surgical exclusion of all traffic transactional (BOFU) to protect the brand.

- rolex where to buy/-rolex delivery - Blocks intent phrases purchase/transaction.

- investment rolex / -swiss rolex - Avoids associations that the brand does not intend (transactional and generic).

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- rolex pepsi / -rolex hulk - Blocks generic nicknames that demonstrate superficial knowledge of the brand.

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07 VISUAL ANALYSIS

(INCLUDES EVALUATION OF ASSETS, LANDING PAGES AND JOURNEY OF CONSUMER)

GRAND SEIKO

Firstly, we start with the headlines, in the case of Grand Seiko we can note that there is a concern to keep them simple, clear and congruent with the Brand's philosophy.

The brand seeks to reinforce the idea that it is the ideal option for those looking for a piece created by hand, with a focus on precision that only the "Land of the Rising Sun" (Japan) can deliver.

Next, and evaluating the descriptions, we find phrases that complement synergize the headlines.

References to watchmaking excellence, Japanese culture, unique, classic and elegant, date of foundation and the "Takumi" (The Craftsman) spirit, continues to reinforce the image of what Grand Seiko is and what it values and intends to convey with emphasis on storytelling that is done in a cohesive way.

In the case of the main result, there seem to be only two descriptions that always appear paired, after 20 searches (Allows the brand to make sure that no combination of descriptions can "say" something that the brand does not want)

Regarding the Display Path, we can observe the lack of customization, omission that aligns with the default state of the Business Logo asset. This choice reflects Grand Seiko's priority to focus investment on ROI, to the detriment the additional cost of bidding and optimizing visual assets to reinforce Branding.

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The simplicity in Grand Seiko's visual assets, noted in the absence of customization of the Display Path and Business Logo, is a conscious choice of efficiency and not an omission due to lack of technical competence. The brand chooses to invest its resources in maximizing the ROI of each click, to the detriment of the additional cost of maintaining heavier branding assets.

This minimalist approach, which prioritizes functionality and speed of loading, directly translates into the agile performance of your website on mobile devices. Grand Seiko thus demonstrates that its marketing focus is not the creation of the aura (a task that you delegate to your craft Ethos), but rather the cost optimization and speed to close the transaction in the funnel.

The chosen Sitelinks (or at least the ones that Google decided to show) present with the aim of converting and at the same time, but on a smaller scale, helping to give the final “push” for the customer to enter the purchasing mindset through information and strengthening authority.

We can also see that, although some of the entries lead to the “website” of the brand (its homepage), most of these sitelinks direct through your headlines and descriptions attract customers to a moment of purchase (conversion) which is cemented by the fact that the redirection is done to landing pages identical but different in terms of what they offer.

While <https://www.grand-seiko.com/pt> directs us to a landing page, in this case the homepage of the most informational website (MOFU), the URL <https://www.grandseikoboutique.eu/en/> is the brand's online boutique page that is intended for conversion (BOFU).

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Figure 8-Landing Page Website Above the Fold (MOFU)

Figure 9-Landing Page Boutique Online Above the Fold (BOFU)

There is also a concern to maintain this visual consistency within the website (on those pages through which there is subsequent navigation), between website main and boutique in terms of style, but with strategic differences.

Comparing, for example, the collection pages, we can then see the differences between the content presented.

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Figure 10-Website Collections Page (MOFU)

Figure 11-Boutique Collections Page (BOFU)

Here you can differentiate between the collections version of the site and the one that is the interpretation of the Online Shop.

The difference between the Website collections page (MOFU) and the Boutique (BOFU) highlights Grand Seiko's strategy of segmenting users who want information of the one who wants the immediate price.

Something that helps demonstrate this partnership between the greatest desire to guarantee conversions and the least need to establish notoriety is the homepage design of the website in the Under the Fold section.

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After performing the initial scroll we can see that in terms of technical information, the page does not include it until the area just above the footer where we can find a link that we can follow to a page that takes us through the brand's history.

Figure 12-First appearance of informational content on the Landing Page.

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Figure 13-History Page

If the visitor “lands” on the website’s Homepage and not the boutique’s, the brand also prepared a “journey” that will end on the boutique’s page.

Starting by choosing a collection, the user is directed to a page which contains an overview of the collection and the models that make up it.

Figure 14-Sport Collection

Once you have chosen the desired model, follow the specifications page where you can find you can find the button (CTA) that takes the visitor to the online boutique where they can find the specifications again, albeit in truncated form, and add the product to cart.

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Figure 15-Product specifications page

Figure 16-Product Page

We can therefore conclude that the content aimed at the MOFU visitor is present, but mostly to help you “confirm” your decision and finish your journey with the purchase, or conversion (BOFU).

The distinction between the two brands is also evident in their bidding policies and mobile user experience. Grand Seiko, obsessed with ROI, tends to operate with stricter maximum CPC (Cost per Click) limits, which leads it to sacrifice premium position at the top of the screen for a lower cost per purchase.

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Figure 17-Here you can see a CPC limit in action.

Interestingly, this prioritization of efficiency is reflected in the performance of your mobile website, which is exceptionally fast and snappy. On the other hand, Rolex, having as a policy Absolute control of position (and status), pay whatever is necessary to never fall to the bottom of the page, thus avoiding digital humiliation. No However, the cost of this authority, manifested in pages with more high-quality assets, setting, results in slightly slower loading on mobile devices, a small price to pay for aspirational perfection.

SUMMARY:

Strengths: High number of sitelinks loaded on the platform, clarity of writing, descriptions and appeals to interest through the use of references to work handmade

Weaknesses: Main link, Sitelinks and Landing Page too different in funnel terms (MOFU/BOFU main ad + BOFU sitelinks + BOFU Landing Page), lack of customization in the business logo and display path, headlines and descriptions feature a mix of languages, some of the sitelinks with headlines and descriptions Different pages ended on the same pages.

Highlights: Visually stunning Landing Page, Website Homepage and Boutique identical, bring an interesting homogenization.

Improvement Suggestions: Greater targeting (more ad groups) in order to avoid mixing MOFU and BOFU traffic. Be careful to keep sitelinks consistent across

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funnel phase, homogenize presented languages, add information related to the business in this case the business logo, Creation of specific Landing Pages for receive traffic from paid ads, in order to simplify the process even further.

ROLEX:

Rolex, like Grand Seiko, remains consistent in the way it highlights those that are the basic characteristics of the Swiss brand, both in terms of precision of their movements, but also their longevity and resistance.

The luxury public, specifically the HNWI (High Net Worth Individuals), follows distinctive sailing patterns that Rolex capitalizes on. Searching for products high aspirational value tends to occur on desktop or larger screens, and many times during office hours, in the consideration phase (MOFU). This Research environment demands visual perfection and unquestionable authority. Rolex's obsession with delivering high-definition hero shots and the exclusion of transactional terms (price/buy) are not accidental, but rather strategies that align with customer psychology, ensuring that the brand is consumed in an environment of contemplation, seriousness and not impulse buying.

Your headlines are short, but clear enough to convey a faithful image of what those who view the ad will be able to find when clicking on these links.

It is also important to mention the introduction of the registered trademark symbol whenever it is the brand name is used (more on this subject later)

Some are more general, others more specific, but they are all positioned perfectly to help fulfill the objective of this ad.

On the description side, care is taken to strike a balance between brevity (to allow faster and more complete reading) and the simplicity of the information present (to ensure that whoever carries it is directed to the place where they thought which would stop before clicking, which allows you to reduce, for example: the bounce rate)

Words and expressions such as: reliability, performance, timeless, "expertise", "know-how", "decision that will last a lifetime", "we value the invisible" and "We have a history of precision", always with the aim of reinforcing its authority.

Similar to what happens with the Japanese brand, there is also the presence of only two descriptions, this limitation allows the brand to control the

narrative and not leave such a decision in the hands of the Google algorithm.

Contrary to what Grand Seiko does, the Swiss brand customizes its Display Path, albeit in a simple way (Just with the addition of Rolex), and adds your

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Business Logo in order to add more authority to your ad at the same time which increases the confidence of those who see it.

Rolex's approach to sitelinks is different, which is justified given that their goals are different.

Since Rolex's intentions are solely to capture MOFU traffic, sitelinks are indicative of this reality.

The Geneva Brand chooses, unlike Grand Seiko, to popularize its space for sitelinks with informational destinations, either through making the collection and its complications or through the emphasis given to its materials and efforts cultural values, which accentuates their place and impact in the cultural Zeitgeist and their perception Status Symbol.

Whatever the Landing Page, be it main result or sitelink, the visitor is received with high-definition hero shots and an ideal amount of information for anyone trying to understand what makes these specimens special, what means some unknown terminology or that has happened to the brand ambassadors.

Here we try to make the visitor “drool” when observing the pieces, and implant the desire aspirational in their mind, references to prices or payment methods and Rolex would risk “killing” the dream in the mind of its future customer.

Figure 18-Landing Page Rolex

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In the specific case of Rolex, and since on its website it is not possible to buy absolutely nothing, it acts as a virtual catalog and at the same time as way of maintaining the “aura” of authority that the brand has, being by far the brand of most recognized watches on the planet.

Figure 19-Example of how Rolex demonstrates authority and the way it communicates

Another subtle but strategic difference manifested itself in loading speed of Landing Pages on mobile devices. While Grand's website and boutique Seiko demonstrated fast and snappy charging, in line with their philosophy efficiency and with a lighter asset weight, Rolex was slightly slower. This small delay is a natural consequence of the brand's need Switzerland in presenting hero shots and very high definition assets that support your aspirational value, sacrificing speed for visual perfection."

Something extra the brand is willing to do to ensure it doesn't risk the visitor “slides” out of the intermediate phase, the final one, of consideration is the process to keep (assumed through cookies) information from the last clock seen so that the next time you are confronted with the ad you can “get” the process exactly where you left it.

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Figure 20-Section that recalls the last watch seen

Even though cookies have an “expiration date” (for Google 400 days, for Apple

7) what probably happens here is a “renewal” of the cookie whenever the user visits the website again, which removes some of the friction of use at a very important time, such as the consideration or

MOFU.

Figure 21-Page where, after 5 clicks, the price is revealed

A choice that the brand makes, certainly consciously, is to hide any reference to the price of your product, both on the landing page and in the rest of the website, even though it exists on the website, it is behind 5 clicks, which illustrates the

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the brand's aversion to making any reference to the purchase transaction, during the visitor's normal journey through the website.

SUMMARY:

Strengths:

120 years of history manifest themselves in the form of communication maturity; clarity of language; consistency of headlines and descriptions; there is a concern that all sitelinks coexist in the same funnel phase; Landing Page remembers the last visit; Almost psychotic segmentation of your groups ads so that any user is redirected exactly to the page that best satisfies your search intent; Business Logo and Display Path personalized

Weak Points:

The only weak point I can point out is that, due to the nature of the website being a page directed to Portugal and Brazil, (<https://www.rolex.com/pt-br>), the headlines and descriptions are written in Brazilian Portuguese.

Highlights:

Content perfection, on the Landing Page the Above the Fold aesthetic is incredible

Improvement Suggestions:

Use of Portuguese from Portugal in Ads delivered in Portugal.

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08 ROLEX: THE WEAPON

SECRET

Rolex's true mastery of Google Search Ads culminates in its ability to dominate the physical space on the results page. Thanks to their 'Secret Weapon', the duo strategy of bidding on your own behalf for MOFU keywords and 'calling in reinforcements' of Authorized Distributors (DA) for BOFU keywords, the brand can occupy an impressive slice of Above the Fold.

On mobile devices, this strategy is even more effective, allowing Rolex and your DA's fill the entire screen with their sequential ads.

On the desktop, the presence is equally dominant. This "cheating" tactic ensures that the consumer who searches for a Rolex is confronted with the brand and its network of sales at all high-intent points, sealing total control of the journey digital.

During the construction of this work, some crumbs were left behind. regarding the way in which Rolex avoids "getting involved" with traffic that comes with intention to convert (BOFU), this happens because luxury goods are seen in a different from the rest.

Much of the appeal of this type of goods comes from the fact that they are exclusive ("they are for those who can and not for those who want"), and sometimes limited, and this scarcity is what most often leads to the desire to purchase.

Another factor that contributes to the popularity of a watch is the difficulty of obtaining, in the specific case of Rolex, has existed for a few years (coincidentally perhaps since the period leading up to COVID) an effort to increase the aura of "blessing" which is being allocated a part (the waiting time for certain steel models can reach 3 years) while reinforcing the idea of scarcity (which is seen by "insiders" as artificial scarcity) and leads the public to believe that it is not the brand that You have to convince the customer, but rather the customer convinces the brand that they are worthy (the requirement being the purchase of some less desirable models in order to inflate sales figures).

On the one hand, Grand Seiko, due to its youth in the Western market (present since 2017), opts for a mixed approach. This strategy seems to denote a

lack of focus on directing traffic via GSA, even though the ultimate goal is

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convert (or at least that's what I infer). The brand also aims to give meet collectors on this side of the Atlantic to consolidate your presence in Europe.

On the other hand, Rolex maintains its stance, seeking to preserve its image of exclusivity and its status as a coveted brand.

The Swiss Brand knows that begging for sales is not “sexy” and instead intends to digitally and through your ads, landing pages and website, make the potential customer comes to this conclusion on his own (he sells the watch to himself) without who feels that the brand is “pushing” him towards “something”, but his mastery and insight developed over more than 100 years of experience has allowed him find a way to do so without tarnishing your image.

The Rolex Authorized Distributors (AD) network has achieved legendary status due to way in which the brand controls them, at a time when several models yield more money on the secondary market than your “MRSP”, even though “DA’s” are tempted to profit from this fact, the Swiss brand follows the numbers series and anyone caught in one of these schemes will no longer receive watches. But when it comes to digital marketing, being part of this network is a mutually beneficial.

Rolex's secret is to advertise its products directly to consumers, but on behalf of its distributors.

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Figure 22-Transparency Center page demonstrates the tactic used by Rolex.

In the Rolex account, ROLEX SA, we can see that there are ads running to promote official distributors and not the Rolex brand, this way the Swiss brand can guarantee total control of qualified traffic that is part of the last two phases of the funnel, MOFU and BOFU, thus managing to avoid “selling” and at the same time your branding remains strong in terms of desirability while ensuring it doesn't lose its hotter traffic.

This way you can also combine all your Google Ads metrics in one place and segment your data in relation to two different funnel stages.

Example:

Someone has just been promoted, with this promotion comes a considerable bonus, This person saw a Rolex print ad in Forbes magazine that conveys the message that anyone who is “something” wears a Rolex.

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This individual, let's call him Carlos, wants to be something and so decides buy a Rolex Daytona with your big bonus (the one you saw in the ad), at this moment Carlos was exposed to TOFU content, which is what, in this case, happens outside of digital.

Figure 23-Print Ad Rolex Daytona

Then he arrives home and decides that he is going to do some research to find out more about the Daytona, enter "rolex daytona" in the search bar and find the brand's ad, when you click, received with a high-definition hero shot and information on how the watch, what the specifications are and, after 5 clicks, find out the price.

Carlos just got "hit" with MOFU content, after finding out the price realizes that the value would consume the bonus in its entirety and decides to wait a few days and think about it better.

For Rolex, the work of its ad in its own name ended here, it attracted traffic lukewarm for your page and when you left it it came out "hot", it showed quality, history and authority, demonstrating to the visitor the value of your product.

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Figure 24-Ad Rolex Brand

It is at this stage that the “secret weapon” comes in, Carlos having decided that you can only live once time, proceed to purchase, this time you do not search for “rolex daytona” but rather “rolex daytona buy”, as we saw, Rolex does not advertise for this keyword, but Torres Jewellers, official distributor of Rolex, does it.

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Figure 25- Ad Rolex Torres Joalheiros

Carlos is directed to the Torres Joalheiros website, “landing” on the product page and order your piece.

This way Rolex has full control over the part of the process that takes place in the digital (MOFU+BOFU), but the end consumer has no idea of the effort that Rolex did to guarantee the sale and thus maintain its brand image, one that does not You have to convince no one to buy your products.

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09 CONCLUSION

At the end of this analysis, it is necessary to conclude with a summary of the issues “surveyed” so far, the amount of information this document contains results in a high probability of duplicate or incomplete reasoning, something that is want to avoid.

When we talk about the approach of each of these brands, the difference is evident. between an industry giant and a brand trying to consolidate itself in this sector, while Grand Seiko chooses to focus on the Action phase (BOFU) and looks at the Consideration phase (MOFU) as a by-product, the Swiss giant executes a complete concert without missing a note (MOFU of the highest level) and still blesses the public with an encore (With its “promotion” in the names of Distributors Authorized, BOFU).

Rolex's expertise goes beyond simple keyword management and culminates in its ability to dominate physical space on the results page.

Thanks to this dual strategy, which bids on its own behalf for MOFU and “call in reinforcements” from your Authorized Distributors (ADs) for keywords BOFU, the brand manages to occupy an impressive share of “Above the Fold” in first page of Google Search Results.

On mobile devices, this 'cheating' tactic is even more effective, allowing Rolex and their network to fill the entirety with their sequential ads.

This physical dominance ensures that the consumer searching for a Rolex is confronted with the brand and its sales network at all high-intent points, allowing the Geneva brand full control of the digital journey and reinforcing its unquestionable authority.

If we evaluate the construction of the ads, both brands manage to convey their Ethos through its headlines and descriptions and none of its “texts” sound dissonant with its ideals, unfortunately Grand Seiko “fails” in the creation and choice of sitelinks, where it mixes MOFU and BOFU sitelinks despite “running” more than one ad group and often uses the same landing page for sitelinks too different.

Personalization is also a failure on the part of Grand Seiko, where Rolex

personalize your ad with business logo and display path the Japanese house is not

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cares about these details, which demonstrates its priority in “ROI” in at the expense of the cost of optimizing branding assets.

This tactic is intrinsically linked to the Seiko group's “SMILE145 Plan”, which dictates the aggressive growth of the Grand Seiko brand, indicating that conversion is the focus absolute in the short term and that pure branding is, at the moment, a secondary cost.

In short, Grand Seiko demonstrates success in executing its corporate mandate to maximize ROI, despite the inherent inefficiencies of a brand in the of rapid growth.

However, its challenge lies in coming face-to-face with the supreme optimization of the Google Search Ads universe: Rolex (at least within its industry), whose strategic execution proves that Google Search Ads, when dominated, it is the most faithful and controlled reflection of the authority of a luxury brand.

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